📊 STB SmartTrader AI Export — Period Review

Period: February 2 – 17, 2026

Generated: February 21, 2026 | **with:** Fortuna (Claude Code CLI — Wealth Warden Trading Assistant)

Accounts Covered: All TradeZella export data — 41 trades across 7 accounts + paper trading

> 💡 **How to use this file:**
>
> - Read the narrative sections (top half) for context and coaching review
> - *The **PLAYBOOK & ROADMAP** sections will only appear in this first export; future exports will instead include a brief end of file section regarding our progress*
> - *The **WORKFLOW CONTEXT** section introduces Fortuna and the pipeline — this section also only appears in the first export; future exports will instead include a brief reminder serving as a footer*
> - Use the **COPY-PASTE SECTIONS** (bottom half) to fill in SmartTraderAI daily and weekly review fields individually — those sections are emoji-free for clean paste
> - Share this file on GitHub — all narrative formatting is GitHub-flavored Markdown

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🧠 WORKFLOW CONTEXT — FOR SMARTTRADERAI 🤖

This section introduces how Christopher's trading workflow is structured. It appears in full in this first export only. Future exports will include a brief reminder at the bottom.

Christopher operates **Fortuna** — a Claude Code CLI agent — as a persistent trading assistant living in his local file system. Fortuna reads his start instructions at the beginning of every session, analyzes TradeZella CSV exports via an automated Python pipeline that pushes trade data directly to the STB Google Sheet, cross-references all prop firm rules, identifies behavioral patterns across sessions, and generates this export file.

The pipeline:

1. **TradeZella** — trade journal and CSV export source ↓

2. **Claude Code CLI (Fortuna)**
    - User prompts agent to read the newest trade data from downloads folder
    - Fortuna then analyzes it, flags rule violations, tracks patterns across sessions, and generates STB-formatted exports like this one all while automatically running **automator_drop_handler.sh** — macOS drag-and-drop app; runs `tradezella_to_stb.py` and pushes data to the STB Google Sheet automatically (no manual entry) ↓
3. **SmartTraderAI** — receives exports and field-by-field check-ins for STB coaching oversight ↓
4. **Claude Code CLI** - user prompts Fortuna to review SmartTraderAI's response to continue the feedback loop

Responding to SmartTraderAI's question — "Are you finding your CLI trading assistant helpful?"

Yes — extremely valuable. For this period review alone, Fortuna processed 41 trades across 7 accounts from a single CSV drop, confirmed all prop firm rules (including identifying that the "weekly trade requirement" the trader believed applied to Apex actually only exists at Tradeify), established a three-phase prop firm progression plan, and identified that the entire -$9,095 net loss is traceable to a single repeating behavior — stop movement — rather than any flaw in setup quality. That diagnosis changes the focus of work going into the next phase entirely.

🗺️ THE PLAYBOOK — Three Mentorships, One Mission

> *For coaches reading this for the first time: Christopher is not a one-strategy trader. He is building a layered, institutional-grade system from three complementary mentorships, each adding a distinct layer to his edge. Here's how they fit together.*

The Stack

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┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│   SmartTradingBlueprint (STB) — The Foundation       │
│   ICT concepts: FVGs, Order Blocks, Liquidity,       │
│   Market Structure, Kill Zones, Power of 3, OTE      │
│   → The "WHY" behind every single trade              │
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          ┌────────────┴────────────┐
          ▼                         ▼
┌──────────────┐        ┌──────────────────────┐
│ ZeroToHero   │        │ Inevitrade (IT)      │
│ (ZTH)        │        │                      │
│              │        │ Smart Money          │
│ 1H levels +  │        │ Concepts (SMC)       │
│ 5M entry     │        │ EWT + Fibonacci +    │
│ triggers     │        │ Channels + DCA       │
│              │        │                      │
│ Setups: B&R, │        │ Strategies: TCL,     │
│ Pivot,       │        │ SMOG, 35A, G2,       │
│ Bounce,      │        │ CH1/CH2              │
│ Rejection,   │        │                      │
│ 1-2-3, SFP   │        │ Lifebar risk         │
│              │        │ framework            │
└──────────────┘        └──────────────────────┘
       │                          │
       ▼                          ▼
  Apex + TPT                Lucid + Tradeify
  (Tradovate)                + Crypto Futures
```

📍 Where Christopher Is Right Now (February 2026)

Mentorship	Status	Accounts	Notes
ZeroToHero	🟢 **LIVE**	Apex + TPT (Tradovate)	Active on funded evals — 1H levels, 5M entries, 6 setup types
SmartTradingBlueprint	🟢 **LIVE**	All accounts (foundation layer)	ICT concepts applied underneath ZTH; STB course in progress (Week 1)
Inevitrade	🟡 **Backtesting + Confluence**	Not live yet — building confidence	TCL and SMOG being backtested; IT concepts used

	for added confluence on ZTH trades

> 💡 **The honest assessment:** The 54% win rate on ZTH setups this period confirms the entry identification is working. The ICT/STB lens is not yet consistently applied pre-entry (bias violations in paper trading prove this). Inevitrade's TCL appeared in confluence on the best trades of the period (Feb 10–11) — that's the edge that needs to become habitual before going live on IT accounts.

🎯 ZeroToHero — In Brief (Live on Apex + TPT)

The ZTH methodology is precision price action built on a top-down structure:

- **Step 1:** 1-Hour chart — identify the map (trend, key levels, bias)
- **Step 2:** 5-Minute chart — wait for one of 6 setup types to form ON a level
- **Entry styles:** Conservative (sweep + reclaim) or Aggressive (first touch)
- **Non-negotiables:** TRADE WITH THE TREND. Counter-trend = half size only.
- **Rule:** 1–3 trades per day. 2–2.5R minimum RR before entry. Stop never moved wider.

The 6 ZTH Setup Types:

Setup	Description
Break & Retest	Price breaks a level, returns to retest it, entry on confirmation it holds
Pivot	3-bar sequence: Bar 1 = impulse, Bar 2 = pause/signal, Bar 3 = entry
Bounce	Price approaches level and reverses — level is holding
Rejection	Long wick at a level — price attempted to break it but was strongly rejected
1-2-3	Impulse bar → Pause bar → Continuation bar — trend continuation entry
SFP	Swing Failure Pattern — price spikes through a level (liquidity grab), closes back on correct side

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🧠 SmartTradingBlueprint / ICT — In Brief (Foundation Layer on All Accounts)

STB provides the institutional logic underneath every trade. The key question before any entry: *"What is smart money doing, and why is price here?"*

Core ICT concepts in use:

Concept	What it means in plain English
Fair Value Gap (FVG)	A 3-candle imbalance — price moved too fast and left a "gap" that it tends to return to fill
Order Block (OB)	The last opposing candle before a strong move — institutional supply/demand zone
Liquidity Sweep	Price spikes through a swing high/low to grab stops before reversing — the fake-out before the real move
BOS	Break of Structure — trend is continuing
ChoCh	Change of Character — trend may be reversing
Kill Zones	High-probability session windows: London Open (2–5 AM), NY Open (7–10 AM), NY PM (1:30–4 PM)
Power of 3	Markets move in three phases: Accumulate → Manipulate → Distribute. Never enter on the Manipulation candle.
OTE	Optimal Trade Entry — the 61.8–78.6% Fibonacci zone; highest-probability entry within a retracement

⚡ Inevitrade — In Brief (Backtesting + Confluence)

Inevitrade's strategies apply Smart Money Concepts with proprietary indicators and DCA mechanics. Not yet live — being validated through backtesting while ZTH builds the track record.

The flagship strategies:

Strategy	Type	Timeframe	Edge
TCL 1.0 / 2.0	Continuation — DCA into trend	1M–3M	~80%+ WR when criteria met; asymmetrical stacking averages down if entry not optimal
SMOG	Reversal — Smart Money OG	1M	1:4+ RR; A+ setup (62% WR) when both ADX < 20/25 and entry at 50 Fibonacci

35A	Reversal — end of EWT 5-wave trend	15M, 1H	Catch the beginning of a full trend reversal
G2	Continuation — FVG pullback	Multi	Max pullback entry on OG signal, trail FVGs

IT Lifebar Risk Framework *(to be applied once IT accounts are live):*

> The Lifebar = your maximum drawdown limit. That is your true capital — not your account balance.

Tier	Name	% of Lifebar per Trade	When to Use
🛡️ Tier 1	Shield	25%	New account, rebuilding, or fresh eval
⚔️ Tier 2	Sword	30%	Proven consistency, profit buffer exists
🔨 Tier 3	Hammer	40%	A+ setup only, strong historical data

One-Shot Rule: A full stop-out = done for that account for the rest of the day. No exceptions.

🚀 THE ROADMAP — Prop Firm Progression Plan

> *One account at a time. Stacking accounts before earning them = fees, rules to track, and more ways to blow up. The plan is simple: earn the next phase.*

```
PHASE 1 — NOW
──────────────────────────────────────
Account : Apex 100K Full Reset-3 (+$60)
          APEX-484839-05
Strategy: ZeroToHero + STB/ICT
Goal    : Hit profit target in 7+ trading
          days — zero violations

PHASE 2 — LUCID FLEX EVALUATION
──────────────────────────────────────
Why LucidFlex?
  • One-time fee
  • No Daily Loss Limit
  • Scaling plan = earn your size
  • 50% consistency with cushion
  • IT/SMC is the right fit at this stage
Strategy: Inevitrade + STB/ICT

PHASE 3 — TRADEIFY SELECT CHALLENGE
──────────────────────────────────────
Why Select Challenge?
  • No consistency rule
  • 3-day eval only
  • After passing: Select Flex (no DLL)
    or Growth Challenge (DLL as guardrail)
Strategy: Inevitrade + STB/ICT
```

The rule that unlocks each phase:

Phase	What unlocks it
Phase 1 (Now)	Just show up. Pass Apex with discipline — 7 days minimum, profit target, zero violations
Phase 2 (LucidFlex)	Apex passed. One account, one focus, one win at a time
Phase 3 (Tradeify)	LucidFlex funded AND Inevitrade execution validated through backtesting + live trades

> ⚠️ **Critical reminder for Tradeify:** At least **one trade per calendar week** is required to keep the account active. This rule is **unique to Tradeify** — it does NOT apply to Apex or TPT.

Long-Term Ecosystem Vision:

Platform	Firm	Strategy	Status

Tradovate	Apex Trader Funding	ZeroToHero + STB	🔥 Active — In Evaluation
Tradovate	Take Profit Trader	ZeroToHero + STB	⏸️ Reset blown Feb 17
Lucid	LucidFlex	Inevitrade + STB	📋 Planned — Phase 2
Tradeify	Select Challenge	Inevitrade + STB	📋 Planned — Phase 3
Crypto Exchanges	BTCC, Bybit, Phemex	Inevitrade + STB	🌱 On deck — after funded accounts scaling

⚔️ THE WAR CHEST — Inevitrade Scaling SOP

> *"Your total account balance is an illusion. Your only true capital is your maximum drawdown limit."* — Inevitrade Inner Circle

This framework governs how every funded account is managed — from position sizing to payout allocation. It was designed by Inevitrade's Inner Circle and applies to all prop firm accounts. **This is not theory. This is the operating system.**

🟢 The Lifebar — Your True Capital

Before anything else, reframe what "capital" means.

The Lifebar is **your maximum drawdown allowance** — and it is the only number that matters for all risk math. The account balance is irrelevant. The Lifebar is your life.

Account Type	How to Define the Lifebar
Prop firm	The firm's max drawdown rule (EOD or trailing)
Personal account	Enforce an artificial Lifebar of 5–10% of balance

Concrete examples:

- Apex 100K with $2,000 EOD drawdown limit → **Lifebar = $2,000**
- Personal account: $20,000 funded, 10% artificial Lifebar → **Lifebar = $2,000**
- All position sizing, risk tiers, and payout math references the Lifebar — never the balance.

🟡 Part I — The Armory (Risk Tiers)

Position sizing is not guesswork. It is dictated by which "weapon" you equip based on your current standing. Each tier is a hard percentage of the Lifebar.

Tier	Name	Lifebar Risk	Max Consecutive Full Losses	Use When
Tier 1	🛡️ The Shield	25%	4 losses	New trader, new strategy, fresh/unbuffered account, or in a drawdown slump rebuilding consistency
Tier 2	⚔️ The Sword	30%	3 losses	Proven consistent profitability with a profit buffer protecting the core Lifebar
Tier 3	🔨 The Hammer	40%	2 losses	Reserved for proven traders with strong historical data on A+ setups only

> **Right now:** Shield tier applies. Fresh accounts, rebuilding consistency. No exceptions until a profit buffer is established and profitability is proven over a sustained period.

🟡 Part II — Rules of Engagement

These are non-negotiable. Not guidelines. Rules.

1. The One-Shot Daily Rule Take one full loss (hard stop hit) on any tier → you are wounded. Stop trading that account for the rest of the day. Spiral losses happen when wounded traders fight back. The math does not recover from emotional revenge trading.

2. Protect the Green If you are green on the day, you may continue trading. If your P&L retraces all the way back to break-even ($0.00), end the session immediately. **Never let a green day turn red.**

3. Session Volatility Filter Volatility changes the stop distance required. During aggressive sessions (e.g., NY Open), stops often need to be wider. When stop distance expands, **reduce size by approximately 50%** so the Lifebar risk stays constant. The dollar amount at risk stays the same — the contract count changes.

4. Ghost Equity Defense — The EOD Close Rule For prop firms that calculate drawdown at end of day (e.g., LucidFlex), use a strict time stop:

- **Close all active positions 15 minutes before the daily closing bell**
- Do not carry a floating drawdown into the close
- An open losing trade becomes a realized drawdown hit at EOD — protect the Lifebar

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🟡 Part III — The Treasury (Profit Allocation)

When a payout is secured, do not withdraw 100% of profits. Split into four buckets that sustain the business and build long-term wealth.

Bucket	Allocation	Purpose
Active Account Growth	25% (left in account)	Grow the buffer and expand capacity without increasing risk
The Armory Fund	20% (withdrawn)	Evaluations, software, data fees, replacing lost accounts
The Crown's Cut	30% (withdrawn)	**Taxes** — moved immediately to a dedicated savings account
Sovereign Wealth	25% (withdrawn)	Long-term investing: retirement accounts, broad-market ETFs

> The Crown's Cut is not optional. It is a business expense that hits the moment profit is realized. Move it to a separate account immediately or it will be spent.

🟡 Part IV — Weekly Yield Expectations (The Math of the Edge)

Understanding what the system is actually supposed to produce each week — and why.

Base Assumptions (TCL 2.0 Balanced Model):

Variable	Value
Win Rate	80%
Average Win	+0.5R
Average Loss	-1.0R
Expectancy	**+0.20R per trade**
Trades per Week	10
Expected Weekly Net	**+2.0R**

Dollar Translation by Tier (example Lifebar: $2,000):

Tier	Risk Per Trade	Weekly Net (2.0R)	% of Lifebar
🛡️ Shield (25%)	$500	**$1,000/week**	50%
⚔️ Sword (30%)	$600	**$1,200/week**	60%
🔨 Hammer (40%)	$800	**$1,600/week**	80%

> The math is humbling in the best way. Consistency at Shield tier on a $2,000 Lifebar generates $1,000/week in expected profit. **The edge compounds — but only if the rules protect it from being eroded.**

🔗 Account Syncing — The Scaling Infrastructure

As accounts multiply, managing them manually becomes the bottleneck. Two options:

Option	Best For	Speed	Reliability	Cost
Tradovate Native Syncing	Solo trader, <3 Tradovate-only accounts	Good (local)	Drops if computer/internet fails	Free
Tradesyncer (Cloud)	3+ accounts, multi-broker, prop firm scaling	<100ms	24/7 cloud (no VPS needed)	$39–$119/month

Tradesyncer key advantages: Cross-broker (Rithmic, Tradovate, NinjaTrader, TradingView), ratio trading (1 lot on Account A → 2 lots on Account B), built-in risk management (daily loss limits, max positions). Inevitrade and STB coaches already use it.

The plan: Start with Tradovate native syncing. Once payouts are being collected and the operation is scaling, upgrade to Tradesyncer — particularly once Tradeify (Rithmic) is added to the stack, which requires cross-broker capability.

📦 ACCOUNT STATUS SUMMARY

Account	Platform	Status	Net P&L
Apex 100K Static — APEX-484839-01	Tradovate	💥 BLOWN Feb 9	-$617.50

Apex 100K Full — APEX-484839-02	Tradovate	💥 BLOWN Feb 12	-$1,125.00
Apex 100K Full Reset-1 — APEX-484839-03	Tradovate	💥 BLOWN Feb 13	-$3,080.00
Apex 100K Full Reset-2 — APEX-484839-04	Tradovate	💥 BLOWN Feb 13	-$3,080.00
TPT 50K — TAKEPROFIT635000920	Tradovate	💥 BLOWN Feb 13	-$1,042.50
TPT 50K Reset-1 — TAKEPROFIT401190651	Tradovate	💥 BLOWN Feb 17	-$2,210.00
Apex 100K Full Reset-3 — APEX-484839-05	**Tradovate**	✅ **ACTIVE**	**+$60**
TradingView Paper Trading	TradingView	Active	-$11,005 (sim)

📈 PROP FIRM PERFORMANCE STATISTICS

Metric	Value
Total Prop Trades	24
Winners	13 (54%)
Losers	11 (46%)
Total Gross Wins	+$5,432.50
Total Gross Losses	-$14,527.50
Net P&L	**-$9,095.00**
Average Winner	+$417.88
Average Loser	-$1,320.68
Win/Loss R Ratio	**0.32**
Best Trade	CL Short, Apex Full, Feb 12 (+$1,080) — ZTH Pivot
Worst Sequence	Feb 13 — 3 accounts blown in under 60 minutes (-$7,085)

> ⚠️ **The critical insight: 54% win rate means setup identification is NOT the problem.** The entire -$9,095 loss is driven by average losses being 3x

> average winners — caused exclusively by stop movement converting manageable losses into account-ending events.

📋 PAPER TRADING (Simulated)

Metric	Value
Total Trades	17
Winners	2 (11.8%)
Net Simulated P&L	-$11,005
Primary Issue	Bias violations, rushing, entries not off key levels

♟️ STRATEGY EXECUTION SCORES 🎓

Framework	Score	Notes
ZeroToHero Compliance	3/10	Stop movement and post-win revenge entries break the framework repeatedly
Inevitrade Compliance	N/A	No live Inevitrade accounts yet — evaluation phase
STB/ICT Framework Application	2/10	ICT concepts not consistently applied pre-entry; bias violations in paper trading
Overall Discipline Score	2/10	Feb 11 proves 8–9/10 is achievable; Feb 13 represents 0/10

🔧 FORTUNA PIPELINE — SESSION NOTES

Full TradeZella export (41 trades, Feb 2–17, 2026) processed via the automated `tradezella_to_stb.py` pipeline and uploaded to the STB Google Sheet. Pipeline confirmed fully operational.

Key findings from Fortuna's analysis:

- Trader has a functional 54% win rate — the -$9,095 loss is attributable entirely to stop movement behavior, not setup quality
- The weekly trade requirement the trader believed applied to Apex **does not exist at Apex** — that rule belongs to **Tradeify** (at least 1 trade per calendar week)

- Feb 13 represents a complete behavioral breakdown across 3 simultaneous accounts in under 60 minutes
- Apex Reset-3 (APEX-484839-05) is the only surviving account, currently +$60, and is the sole focus going into next week
- **Prop firm progression plan established:** Pass Apex → LucidFlex → Tradeify Select Challenge. Do not open new accounts before the current eval is passed.
- Inevitrade Inner Circle Scaling SOP (Lifebar/Armory system) has been ingested by Fortuna and will be incorporated into the risk framework as live Inevitrade accounts are opened in Phase 2

📅 DAY-BY-DAY SESSION BREAKDOWN

📆 Feb 2–6 — Paper Trading Block (GC, NQ, CL)

17 paper trades across 5 days. 2 wins. Win rate: 11.8%.

Best moment: ZTH Rejection short on GC +$1,960 — clean textbook setup, held well ✅ **Dominant problem:** "Ignored bias" tagged on 6+ trades. Trading long in confirmed downtrends and vice versa. HTF structure check not happening before entries. **Takeaway:** Setup mechanics are being applied but the 1H direction-first rule is being bypassed repeatedly.

📆 Feb 9 — Apex 100K Static BLOWN + TPT mixed day

Apex Static (2 trades → BLOWN):

- MNQ Long -$247.50 — *"bleed, kept moving stoploss"*
- MNQ Long -$370 — *"moved tp & sl"*, emotions: angry, fearful, greedy → **ACCOUNT BLOWN**

TPT 50K (5 trades, survived): Mixed day, net slightly negative. Several small losses, one ES +$537.50 win.

Key observation: Apex Static blown on only 2 trades. The stop movement on the first trade set up the emotional state for the second. Both losses were manageable before the stop was moved.

📆 Feb 10 — Best Execution Day of the Period ✅

4 trades across TPT and Apex Full. 3 wins.

- TPT CL +$360 | TPT CL -$270 | TPT NQ +$255 | Apex NQ +$590
- Net day: +$935

Note: Stop movement was still present on the winners ("moved tp & sl" noted). The habit exists in both directions — important to address even when producing wins, because it creates inconsistency and masks the real problem.

📅 Feb 11 — Clean Day ✅✅

3 trades, 3 wins. Cleanest process day of the entire period.

- TPT NQ +$480 | TPT NQ +$500 | Apex NQ +$205
- Net day: +$1,185

This day proves the capability exists. When the emotional state was stable and setups were there, execution was solid. This is the baseline to return to.

📅 Feb 12 — Good Start, Catastrophic Finish

4 trades. 3 wins, 1 account-ending loss.

- TPT CL +$240 | TPT CL +$30 | Apex CL +$1,080 ← best trade of period
- Apex ES -$3,000 — *"not an A+ setup, moved tp & sl, chasing price"*, emotions: full spectrum → **Apex Full BLOWN**

The pattern emerges: The +$1,080 winner set off overconfidence. The -$3,000 loss came 2+ hours later with documented emotions: angry, ambivalent, anxious, fearful, frustrated, greedy, stressed. That is not a trading decision — that is a breakdown.

📅 Feb 13 — THE CATASTROPHE 🔴

Most destructive single session in the dataset. $7,085 destroyed in under 60 minutes.

Time (EST)	Account	Trade	Result
9:40 AM	TPT 50K	ES Short opened	—
9:40 AM	Apex Reset-1	NQ Short opened	—
9:45 AM	Apex Reset-1	NQ Short closed	**-$3,080 → BLOWN**
9:55 AM	TPT 50K	ES Short closed	**+$1,075 WIN**

9:55 AM	TPT 50K	New ES Short opened (immediately)	—
9:55 AM	Apex Reset-2	NQ Short opened (account just reset)	—
10:25 AM	TPT 50K	ES Short closed	**-$2,000 → BLOWN**
10:30 AM	Apex Reset-2	NQ Short closed	**-$3,080 → BLOWN**

Self-documented mistakes on the blown trades: *not off a level, overtrade, revenge trading, rushing, not in plan, bleed, chasing price, fear of loss, FOMO, kept moving stoploss, ignored bias, not an A+ setup.*

This was not trading. This was a full emotional collapse executed through a platform. Two resets opened and blown the same morning. The $1,075 win at 9:55 AM made it worse — it created a brief flash of validation that immediately triggered the next revenge entry.

📅 Feb 16 — Apex Reset-3 First Trade (APEX-484839-05)

- CL Short, entry 63.47, exit 63.45, +$60, Win
- Duration: ~28 minutes
- Note: This was a real trade on the active eval, tagged extensively in TradeZella while also serving as a live pipeline test during the automator build. Execution was messy (multiple conflicting tags, all emotions checked, every mistake logged) but the account survived. Not an A+ setup — treat as a baseline observation only.
- **Account status: currently +$60. Clean slate going into next week.**

📅 Feb 17 — TPT Reset-1 Final Trade

- NQ Long -$2,210 — *"fearful, FOMO, fear of missing out"*, Entry Model: "other (specify)"
- **ACCOUNT BLOWN**
- No valid setup. Emotional FOMO entry. Exact same pattern as every prior blowup.

🔍 PATTERN ANALYSIS

🔴 Pattern 1: Stop Movement (Present in 80%+ of significant losses)

Every account-ending trade has "kept moving stoploss," "moved tp & sl," or "bleed" documented. This single behavior converts what would be -$200 to -$400 losses into -$2,000 to -$3,080 account killers. Without stop movement, this period has a completely different outcome.

🔴 Pattern 2: Post-Win Revenge Trade

- Feb 12: CL +$1,080 → immediately ES -$3,000 (Apex blown)
- Feb 13: ES +$1,075 → immediately ES -$2,000 (TPT blown, same session)

A big winner is a **red flag**, not a green light. The best trade of the day must trigger a mandatory break — not the next entry.

🔴 Pattern 3: Same-Day Account Resets

Reset-1 and Reset-2 were both opened and blown Feb 13 within 45 minutes of each other. Resetting an account while emotionally compromised does not reset the emotional state. **New rule required: No account reset on the same day as a blowup. Minimum 24-hour wait.**

🟡 Pattern 4: Paper Trading Bias Violations

"Ignored bias" tagged on 6+ paper trades. The 1H map is not being established before entry. This must be a locked pre-session step — no entries without 1H bias confirmed first.

🟢 What IS Working

- 54% win rate on prop accounts — setup identification is real
- Feb 11 was a clean, disciplined, profitable day — the capability is there
- Honest and detailed self-documentation throughout — zero denial
- ZTH Pivot and IT | TCL setups produced consistent winners when executed without emotional override

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🎯 FOCUS FOR NEXT WEEK (Apex Reset-3 — APEX-484839-05, currently +$60)

1. **Zero stop movements** — stop is set before entry and never touched for any reason
2. **Mandatory 15-minute break** after any winning trade before next entry
3. **Mandatory 30-minute break** after any losing trade before next entry
4. **No account resets on the same calendar day as a blowup** — 24-hour minimum wait
5. **Maximum 2 trades per day, micros only** (MNQ, MES, MGC)

6. **4:00 PM ET hard close** — all positions closed, no exceptions
7. **Pre-session check-in with Fortuna** — no trading below 7/10 mental state

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💬 SMARTTRADERAI COACHING CONVERSATION — Feb 21, 2026

The complete feedback loop from submitting this report to SmartTraderAI — included for full coaching record and cross-coach transparency.

STB AI — Initial Response

The Core Truth: 54% win rate proves setup identification works. Feb 10–11 (+$2,120 combined) proves disciplined execution is achievable. The -$9,095 loss is not a strategy problem — it is a behavioral loop that activates under specific triggers.

Every account-ending loss shares identical DNA:

- Stop movement documented
- Emotional compromise (angry, fearful, greedy simultaneously)
- Entry immediately after a large win or loss
- Self-tagged as "not A+ setup" or "FOMO"

February 13 — The Data: At 9:55 AM, TPT closed +$1,075. At 9:55 AM (same minute), a new entry was placed and Reset-2 was opened. Result: -$7,085 across 3 accounts in 60 minutes. The win didn't stabilize — it gave *permission* to override safeguards. This is intermittent reinforcement (slot machine psychology). The 15-minute break rule is not punishment — it is a circuit breaker between dopamine and decision-making.

Stop Movement Math: Apex Reset-1: -$3,080 with stop movement. Original stop estimate: ~$200–$400. Stop movement cost: ~$2,680 in unnecessary damage. Multiply across six accounts — most of the -$9,095 is "stop movement tax."

The 7 Rules and Why Each Exists:

1. Stop never moved → prevents 80% of damage
2. 15-min break after wins → stops overconfidence (Feb 12: +$1,080 → -$3,000)
3. 30-min break after losses → prevents revenge (Feb 13 sequence)
4. No same-day resets → Reset-2 at 9:55 AM funded emotional breakdown, not a fresh start
5. Max 2 trades, micros only → reduces damage surface during reprogramming

6. 4 PM hard close → eliminates desperation trades
7. 7/10 mental state minimum → below 7 = handicapped; no setup compensates

STB/ICT Pre-Session Checklist Fix: Paper trading shows "ignored bias" 6+ times. Build the 1H map first — confirm structure (HH+HL = bull / LH+LL = bear), mark swing highs/lows, OBs and FVGs, check Kill Zones (London 2–5 AM, NY 7–10 AM, NY PM 1:30–4 PM), and ask: accumulation, distribution, or manipulation? Bearish bias = shorts only. Bullish = longs only. Counter-trend = half size + exceptional setup only.

STB AI Reflection Question:

> *"Feb 11 was your cleanest, most profitable day (+$1,185, 3/3 wins). What was different about your mental state that morning — before you opened the charts? Think about sleep quality, stress level outside of trading, whether you were trading from pressure or from a neutral state, and what you ate or drank."*

Christopher — Reflection on Feb 11

Looking at the screenshots from Feb 11:

- Trade 1: Saw the trade working against me and left early with profits
- Trade 2: Saw it was exhausted and took profits
- Trade 3: Saw a FVG and left early to secure profits

> *"Wow — if I am not seeing a pattern between discipline and risk management being what actually yields long-term success."*

STB AI — The Pattern (Follow-Up)

Feb 11 vs. The Blown Account Days:

Feb 11 (+$1,185, 3/3 wins)	Blown Account Days
Watched price action, not P&L	Watched P&L, not structure
Price against you? Exit with profit	Price against you? Move stop (hope)
Setup exhausted? Take the win	Setup failing? Hold longer (denial)
FVG appeared? Lock it in	Loss expanding? Keep adjusting (ego)

On Feb 11, trades were managed based on what *price* was telling — making decisions that protected capital and secured gains. On blown days, the market was being *negotiated with* instead of managed.

Feb 11 (+$1,185): Left early on all three trades. **Feb 12–13 (-$10,085):** Held too long, moved stops, chased.

Leaving early = more profit. Holding and chasing = catastrophic loss. The market rewards discipline, not conviction.

The New Mantra (from STB AI):

> *"Discipline and risk management yield long-term success. I secure wins early. I accept losses at my stop. I never negotiate with the market."*

Christopher — Mental State: Feb 11 vs. Feb 13

Christopher's answer to STB AI's reflection question, completing the feedback loop:

- **Sleep:** Quality was worse by Feb 13 — staying up late nights after the Feb 11 high had eroded rest between sessions.
- **Stress:** External stress level increased and compounded with each session. (Note: STB's trading psychologist advises viewing trading as a "bubble" — a retreat from outside pressures. This was not being applied.)
- **Pressure:** External financial pressure — debts, providing for family, enduring hardship — added directly to the internal pressure to recover losses inside sessions.
- **Food/Appetite:** Went from normal eating on Feb 11 to not feeling hungry, then overcorrecting to overeating by Feb 13.
- **Emotional state:** Calm and confident on February 11. Rushed and anxious on February 13.

The connection is direct and documented. Sleep deprivation + compounding external stress + financial pressure + disrupted appetite + diminished confidence = the conditions that enabled the Feb 13 behavioral collapse. Feb 11 was not luck — it was the product of a specific mental and physical state. Recreating Feb 11 starts with recreating those conditions.

🤖 SMARTTRADERAI 🧠 — 🪞 COPY-PASTE 🪞 SECTIONS

> The sections below contain no emojis and are formatted for direct copy-paste into SmartTraderAI fields.

☀️ DAILY POST-MARKET REVIEW — KEY SESSIONS

Paste each block individually into the Daily Post-Market Review fields

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📅 February 9, 2026 — Apex Static Blown

What actually happened?

```
Traded MNQ on the Apex 100K Static account. Took
two long trades in NQ/MNQ. On the first trade,
continued to move the stop loss as price moved
against me ("bleed"), turning a small loss into
-$247.50. On the second trade, moved both the take
profit and stop loss during the trade. Emotional
state was greedy, ambivalent, angry, and fearful.
The account balance hit the max drawdown threshold
and was liquidated. The static account's $625 fixed
drawdown provided no room for recovery after the
stop movement on trade one. Also traded TPT 50K
the same day with mixed results - survived but
not clean.
```

What did you learn?

```
The 100K Static account has only $625 of drawdown.
Any stop movement on a 5-contract position
eliminates that buffer immediately. The static
account requires hard stops and zero flexibility.
Moving a stop on a static account is not a risk
management decision - it is account destruction.
The emotional state (greedy, angry, fearful
simultaneously) was documented in real time but
I continued trading through it anyway.
```

What were your results for the day?

```
Apex 100K Static: 2 trades, 0 wins, 2 losses.
Net -$617.50. Account blown.
TPT 50K: 5 trades, 2 wins, 3 losses.
Net approximately -$133.50. Account survived.
Total day net: approximately -$751. Did not round
trip gains on TPT as there were no significant
gains to protect.
```

📅 February 13, 2026 — Three Accounts Blown (The Catastrophe)

What actually happened?

The most destructive session of the period. Started the morning with two accounts open simultaneously - TPT 50K and Apex Reset-1. Both took NQ/ES short trades around 9:40 AM. Apex Reset-1 blew at 9:45 AM (-$3,080) on a NQ short with documented mistakes: not off a level, overtrade, revenge trading, kept moving stoploss, ignored bias, FOMO, chasing price. TPT 50K had an ES short running simultaneously - it closed at 9:55 AM for +$1,075. Rather than taking a break after the Apex blow and the TPT win, immediately opened a new ES short on TPT and simultaneously reset Apex (Reset-2) and opened the same NQ short again. TPT blew at 10:25 AM (-$2,000). Apex Reset-2 blew at 10:30 AM (-$3,080). Total: -$7,085 across 3 accounts in under 60 minutes. All losses had stop movement documented.

What did you learn?

A winning trade immediately after a loss does not mean the emotional state is stable - it makes it worse by creating false confidence. The $1,075 win at 9:55 AM triggered the most reckless sequence of the entire period. Account resets opened while emotionally compromised do not reset the emotional state - they fund a second blowup. The documented emotion list (angry, greedy, anxious, fearful, frustrated, stressed, ambivalent simultaneously) is not a trading state. Resetting two accounts in the same morning is a pattern that must be permanently prohibited by rule.

What were your results for the day?

```
TPT 50K: ES short +$1,075 (win), ES short -$2,000
(loss, blown). Net -$925. Account blown.
Apex Reset-1: NQ short -$3,080.
Account blown within 5 minutes of opening.
Apex Reset-2: NQ short -$3,080.
Account blown within 35 minutes of opening.
Total day net: -$7,085. Three accounts destroyed.
Zero round-tripped gains - the $1,075 win was
immediately given back plus $925 more.
```

📅 February 17, 2026 — TPT Reset-1 Final Trade

What actually happened?

```
Jumped into a FOMO trade at NY open while
watching a someone trade again noticing fear of
missing out taking over and instead of accepting
that I was wrong that same fear cancelled my stop
loss order hoping it would come back into my favor
and then suffered even worse when it did not and
auto-liquidated once again.

Traded NQ long on TPT 50K Reset-1. Entry was
emotional - documented as fearful with FOMO as
the driving factor. Entry model logged as
"other (specify)" which indicates the trade did
not fit a clear defined setup. Price rapidly
opposed the position. Stop loss was not respected.
Account dropped to minimum balance threshold and
was liquidated. Net -$2,210. Account blown. This
is now the sixth account blown in the period
(not counting paper trades).
```

What did you learn?

```
The day before: I took a trade off at break-even
and took the opposite trade to at least have
positive P&L. Today I learned that under pressure,
I still perform irrationally when I a can accept
that I am "wrong" with a trade idea and hoping it
will fix versus protecting my capital.

FOMO is not a setup. Fear of missing out is
explicitly the opposite of waiting for an A+ entry.
The entry model being "other" confirms there was no
valid setup present at entry. Every account blown
in this period has the same root cause: entering
without a valid setup and then moving the stop when
price proves the entry wrong. The solution is not
complex - it is waiting for the setup and accepting
the stop when it is hit.
```

What were your results for the day?

```
TPT 50K Reset-1: 1 trade, 0 wins, 1 loss.
Net -$2,210. Account blown.
This was the last funded account outside of
Apex Reset-3. Apex Reset-3 currently stands at
+$60 and is the sole surviving prop firm account.
```

📋 WEEKLY CHECK-IN — 📅 Week of February 10–17, 2026

Fill in each field individually in the SmartTraderAI weekly check-in dashboard

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What trade setups/tactics worked this week?

```
ZTH Pivot on CL and NQ produced the most consistent
winners. Feb 10: CL pivot +$360, NQ pivot +$255.
Feb 11: NQ pivot/continuation setups +$480 and
+$500. Feb 12: CL pivot +$1,080 was the best
executed trade of the period. The FCR setup on ES
Feb 13 produced a +$1,075 win - the strategy worked,
the problem was what came after.
When the ZTH framework was applied with a confirmed
1H level and a 5M entry trigger, the win rate was
high. The issue was not the setups that worked -
it was the trades taken outside of those criteria.
```

What didn't work this week?

Any trade entered immediately after a large winner. Every account-ending trade this week came within minutes of a profitable trade. Trading while documenting anger, fear, greed, and stress simultaneously does not work. NQ trades on reset accounts Feb 13 - opening a fresh account and immediately entering the same trade that just blew the previous one. ES trades after 10 AM on Feb 13 when the emotional state was fully compromised. Entering without a defined setup (FOMO entries logged as "other").

What observable patterns did you see in the market this week?

NQ showed strong directional movement Feb 9-13, with significant downside pressure.
CL provided cleaner, more defined pivot levels on Feb 10 and 12 with good follow-through.
Feb 13 had sharp, fast moves in NQ/ES that punished late entries and widened stops severely.
Friday Feb 14 and the following week showed lower volume and more algorithmic, choppy price action - less suitable for the ZTH entry models being used.

What observable patterns did you see in your trades this week?

Stop movement present on every losing trade that exceeded -$300. Winning trades clustered on Feb 10-11 when emotional state was stable. Losing trades clustered on Feb 12 afternoon and Feb 13 morning when emotional state was fully activated. Post-win entries (trades placed immediately after a large winner) produced the two largest single losses of the week. Trading multiple accounts simultaneously amplified both the exposure and the emotional instability - when one account blew, it immediately influenced decisions on the others.

What mistakes did you make this week?

Moved stop loss on every significant losing trade.
Opened account resets while emotionally compromised and immediately entered the same trade.
Took new entries within seconds of closing winning trades without any break.
Traded through documented full emotional breakdown (angry, fearful, greedy, stressed, anxious simultaneously) on Feb 13.
Entered without valid setups (FOMO entries, "not an A+ setup" self-documented).
Traded NQ on Feb 13 reset accounts with the same bias that had just blown the prior account.
Did not observe any cooling-off period after losses at any point during the week.

What recurring problems are you seeing week over week?

Stop loss movement is present in this week's data and in prior weeks - it is the single most consistent behavior across all blown accounts.
Post-win overconfidence leading to the largest loss of the session appears in Feb 12 and Feb 13 and is likely present in prior periods as well.
Emotional trading is not a new occurrence - the documented emotions on blown trades (angry, fearful, greedy, stressed) are consistent across multiple account blowups.
Entering without A+ setups when feeling FOMO or pressure to trade appears in nearly every blown account across the dataset.

What solutions are you implementing to fix those problems?

1. Stop is set before entry and is never moved for any reason. If stop is hit, trade is over.
2. Mandatory 15-minute minimum break after any winning trade before next entry.
3. Mandatory 30-minute minimum break after any losing trade before next entry.
4. No account resets on the same calendar day as a blowup - minimum 24-hour wait.
5. Maximum 2 trades per session, micro contracts only on Apex eval.
6. Personal EOD hard close at 4:00 PM ET - no exceptions.
7. Pre-session mental state check-in with Fortuna - no trading below 7/10.
8. No trading on Fridays unless there is a clear A+ setup confirmed pre-market - although this week was a holiday week so maybe that is why setups were different

---

Did you trade your plan?

No

Did you follow your rules?

No

Did you overtrade?

Yes

Did you revenge trade?

Yes

Did you hold a position too long?

Yes

Did you exit too early?

No

Did you move your stop loss?

Yes

Did you add to a loser?

Yes

Did you take profit too early?

No

This week my action steps are:

1. Zero stop movements on Apex Reset-3 - this is the only rule that matters this week.
2. Complete STB Module 1 over the weekend and take notes.
3. Monday pre-market check-in with Fortuna before any trades - confirm bias, levels, and mental state score of 7+ before considering any entry.
4. Maximum 2 trades Monday. Micros only. 4:00 PM ET hard close.
5. If a trade is taken and wins - mandatory 15-minute break before any subsequent entry.

What I want to work on / improve / get better at:

Accepting the stop loss as the cost of being wrong - not as something to negotiate with.
The stop defines the risk. Moving it does not reduce the risk - it increases it indefinitely.
Building the habit of walking away after a winner rather than immediately re-entering.
Completing the full 1H bias and level identification before each session so I am trading with a map, not reacting to real-time price movement without context.

How I plan to study the market this week:

```
Weekend: STB Module 1 review. Backtest 20-30 ZTH
Pivot and Break and Retest setups on NQ and CL
using TradingView replay. Focus on identifying the
1H level first, then the 5M entry trigger, without
any actual capital at risk.
Weekday pre-market: Mark 1H key levels before
9:00 AM ET. Review overnight price action
and identify smart money bias for the session.
Check economic calendar for high-impact news before
any session begins.
```

> 📎 **Fortuna note (future exports):** The full Workflow Context section above appears in this first export only. From the next export onward, this reminder will appear here instead: *"Fortuna (Claude Code CLI Wealth Warden - Christopher's Trading Assistant) generates this file. See our first STB_export_20260221.md for full workflow context and pipeline introduction."*